

PYTHON BASICS

Python is a beautiful, clear and easy to use language that you'll find very useful even when you're done with this booklet.

If you have never encountered Python before, you're in for a delightful surprise! Python is a rather popular programming language that you will find somewhere within the top 10 of any language popularity contest. It is famous for being quite readable, easy to understand, and easy to pick up. Hopefully you will find those adjectives appropriate once you are done with this chapter.

One of the unusual aspects of the Python syntax, that helps ensure that most Python code looks neat, clean, and uniform is that code formatting is (to an extent) part of the syntax of the language. Where many programming languages such as C / C++ / Java / C# / JavaScript use curly braces to demarcate blocks of code belonging within a function, class, loop or if statement, Python uses indentation.

If you use an IDE to write code in any of the languages we have mentioned above, chances are it will automatically indent code in addition to placing braces around to make the code look neat and to give developers a better overview of the flow of the code. With Python there are no curly braces, the indentation itself enough — and why not, you would be indenting the code anyway!

Let's look at some simple code in JavaScript and Python to compare. The following code snippets implement one of the most important requirements